

1988

A Mish-Mash Of Things

March: The Protocol We Feed On

Introduced around 1974, the TCP protocol today sends packets of data to the intended recipient and re-sends packets that may have been lost in transit. Its other function is reducing the packet size by half when re-sending lost packets. This functionality was not introduced till 1988.

Before 1988, networks used to get clogged frequently when there were too many users at any point of time; packets got lost more often in transit. When the lost packets of the same size were re-sent out, it caused the network to clog all the more. The overhaul of the TCP protocol ensured its robustness and its continued use even till this day.

October: The NeXTCube

A high-end workstation, manufactured by NeXT Computer Inc., the NeXTCube was launched with the top-of-the-line hardware available at the time. It had a 33 MHz processor, 16 MB of RAM, and 256 MB Magneto-Optical drives. Its OS supported Embedded Link Object and multitasking capabilities. The NeXTCube also sold with a very powerful 400 dpi printer.

The NeXTCube impressed many, and was awarded rave reviews by critics. However, it was priced high, and due to its commercial failure, it was abandoned the next year. A few NeXTCube computers are still in use as servers to this day.



Finally... something that looks like a present-day computer!